

Conditional Statements in Bash

Definition:

Conditional statements in Bash allow you to make decisions in scripts, executing specific commands based on whether a condition is true or false.

Types of Conditional Statements in Bash

1. if Statement

Executes commands only if a condition is true.

Syntax:

```
if [ condition ]  
then  
    commands  
fi
```

Example:

```
a=10  
if [ $a -gt 5 ]; then  
    echo "a is greater than 5"  
fi
```

2. if-else Statement

Executes one block if true, another if false.

Syntax:

```
if [ condition ]
```

```
then
    commands_if_true
else
    commands_if_false
fi
```

Example:

```
num=8
if [ $num -gt 10 ]; then
    echo "Number greater than 10"
else
    echo "Number less than or equal to 10"
fi
```

3. if-elif-else Ladder

Used for multiple conditions.

Syntax:

```
if [ condition1 ]
then
    commands1
elif [ condition2 ]
then
    commands2
else
    commands3
fi
```

Example:

```
marks=75
if [ $marks -ge 90 ]; then
    echo "Grade: A"
```

```
elif [ $marks -ge 75 ]; then
    echo "Grade: B"
else
    echo "Grade: C"
fi
```

4. Nested if Statements

Used when one if is inside another.

Syntax:

```
if [ condition1 ]
then
    if [ condition2 ]
    then
        commands
    fi
fi
```

Example:

```
a=10
b=20
if [ $a -lt 15 ]; then
    if [ $b -gt 15 ]; then
        echo "a < 15 and b > 15"
    fi
fi
```

5. case Statement

Checks a variable against multiple patterns.

Syntax:

```
case $variable in
  pattern1)
    commands
    ;;
  pattern2)
    commands
    ;;
  *)
    default_commands
    ;;
esac
```

Example:

```
echo "Enter a number (1-3):"
read num
case $num in
  1) echo "You chose One" ;;
  2) echo "You chose Two" ;;
  3) echo "You chose Three" ;;
  *) echo "Invalid choice" ;;
esac
```

Common Operators:

Arithmetic: -eq, -lt, -gt, -ne

String: =, !=, -z, -n

File Test: -f, -d, -r, -w, -x

Example Combining All:

```
read -p "Enter your age: " age
if [ $age -lt 13 ]; then
  echo "Child"
```

```
elif [ $age -lt 20 ]; then
    echo "Teenager"
elif [ $age -lt 60 ]; then
    echo "Adult"
else
    echo "Senior"
fi
```

Summary Table

Type	Description	Example	
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if	Runs commands if true	if [\$a -gt 10]; then ... fi	
if-else	Executes one block if false	if [\$x -eq 1]; else ... fi	
if-elif-else	Multiple conditions	if ... elif ... else ... fi	
Nested if	if inside another if	if [...]; if [...]; fi; fi	
case	Pattern-based switch	case \$var in ... esac	